

0.0.1 Andhakavinda

andhakavindasuttaṃ

1. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Andhakavinda in Magadha. At that time the Auspicious One was seated in the open air during the pitch black darkness of the night and the [rain] deva was drizzling drop by drop.

ekam samayaṃ bhagavā māgadhesu² viharati andhakavinde. tena kho pana samayena bhagavā rattandhakāratimisāyaṃ ajjhokāse³ nisinno hoti. devo ca ekamekaṃ phusāyati.

2. Then when the night had advanced, the Brahma Sahampati, of stunning beauty, having illuminated almost the entire Andhakavinda, visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, having bowed down to the Auspicious One, he stood to one side. Having stood to one side, the Brahma Sahampati spoke these verses in the Auspicious One's presence:

atha kho brahmā sahampati abhikkantāya rattiyā abhikkantavaṇṇo kevalakappaṃ andhakavindaṃ obhāsetvā yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā bhagavantaṃ abhivādetvā ekamantaṃ aṭṭhāsi. ekamantaṃ ṭhito kho brahmā sahampati bhagavato santike imā gāthāyo abhāsi:

One should frequent remote lodgings,
 one should fare liberated from the fetters;
 should one not gain delight there,
 then live amidst the Sangha as a self-guarded,
 mindful one.

sevetha pantāni senāsanāni¹,
 careyya saññojanavippamokkhā;
 sace ratim nādhigaccheyya tattha,
 saṅghe vase rakkhितatto satīmā².

Wandering from family to family for alms food,
 that prudent, mindful one, with faculties guarded;
 must frequent remote lodgings,
 free from dread, liberated, fearless.

kulākulaṃ piṇḍikāya caranto,
 indriyagutto nipako satīmā²;
 sevetha pantāni senāsanāni,
 bhayā pamutto abhaye vimutto.

The place where frightful snakes roam,
 wherethe Deva streaks lightning and thunders;
 sitting down in the pitch darkness of the night,
 there, that bhikkhu is rid of dread.

yattha bheravā sirīṃsapā³,
 vijju sañcarati thaneti⁴ devo;
 andhakāratimisāya rattiyā nisīdi,
 tattha bhikkhu vigatalomahaṃso.

This indeed, has undoubtedly been seen by
 me,
 this is not hearsay;
 in [this] life of purity alone,
 a thousand have dispelled death.

idaṃ hi jātu me diṭṭhaṃ,
 nayidaṃ itihītihaṃ;
 ekasmiṃ brahmacariyasmiṃ,
 sahaṃsaṃ maccuhāyinaṃ.

More than five hundred sekhas,
 and ten tenfold are seen;
 all are endowed with the stream,
 not destined for the animal womb.

bhiyyo⁵ pañcasatā sekhā,
 dasā ca dasadhā dasa;
 sabbe sotasaṃāpannā,
 atiracchānagāmino.

But this other population,
 “[those] partaking in merits;”
 this mind of mine is not even able to calculate,
 for fear of uttering false speech.

athāyaṃ itarā pajā,
puññabhāgāti me mano;
saṅkhātuṃ nopi sakkomi,
musāvādassa ottapeti⁶

